

Wednesday, 9 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 19° 13°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 17° 12°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 17° 12°	GLASGOW Overcast 16° 11°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Ports in Southampton and the King's Harbour Master have denied requests to allow 120 migrants to land in RNLI boats.

The decision was made on Sunday, preventing the boats from coming ashore. It follows growing debate around how migrant crossings are handled.

IMMIGRATION · UK
- 2

Prince George has begun his first day at Eton College, following in the footsteps of his father, the Prince of Wales.

The 13-year-old was dropped off at the elite private school by his parents, Prince William and Princess Catherine. It was a rainy start for the young royal.

ROYAL · UK
- 3

England has seen an improvement in its reading, maths, and science rankings, according to the latest Pisa report.

However, the report also highlighted a worrying global decline in teenagers' reading skills. Scotland and Wales, meanwhile, have fallen behind in the rankings.

EDUCATION · UK
- 4

Hopes for falling mortgage rates have been dashed for many borrowers, as major lenders have recently increased rates on new deals.

This leaves many homeowners and prospective buyers facing difficult decisions. The move comes amid ongoing uncertainty in the housing market.

ECONOMY · UK
- 5

The Nottingham Inquiry has heard that the death of one of Valdo Calocane's victims was 'potentially preventable'.

This new information suggests there might have been a chance for one of the victims to survive. The inquiry continues to examine the tragic events.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1 **Nigella Lawson is being praised as the new judge on The Great British Bake Off, as the latest batch of contestants has been announced.**

The popular TV chef joins series 17, bringing her expertise to the famous tent. A new group of hopefuls will soon be battling it out to be crowned Star Baker.

ON AIR – Are you excited about Nigella joining Bake Off? Who do you think will be this year's Star Baker?

TV · AUTUMN

2 **Great news for fans of The Inbetweeners, as Netflix has confirmed a new film with the original lead stars set to return!**

The beloved coming-of-age sitcom is getting another big-screen outing. Jay, Simon, Will, and Neil will be back for more hilarious antics.

ON AIR – Are you looking forward to seeing The Inbetweeners back together? What kind of trouble do you think they'll get into this time?

FILM · COMING SOON

3 **Former wrestler Dave Bautista has been confirmed as the new star of the upcoming God of War adaptation, replacing Ryan Hurst as Kratos.**

Fans of the popular PlayStation series will be keen to see Bautista take on the iconic role. It's a big casting for what's expected to be a major production.

ON AIR – What do you think of Dave Bautista as Kratos? Does he have what it takes to bring the God of War to life?

FILM · FUTURE

4 **Filmmakers have described Oasis's recent Cardiff reunion gig as a 'hugely emotional' experience, which even took Noel Gallagher by surprise.**

The highly anticipated comeback show clearly resonated deeply with both the band and the audience. It sounds like a night to remember for everyone involved.

ON AIR – Were you at the Oasis reunion gig, or did you catch any of the buzz? What's your favourite Oasis song?

MUSIC · RECENT

5 **Andrew Scott is feeling the 'pressure' as he takes on the role of an 'unsung hero' in a new World War Two thriller.**

The actor reveals he approached playing James Stagg, the meteorologist crucial to D-Day's success, with great care. It sounds like a gripping new drama.

ON AIR – Andrew Scott is always brilliant, isn't he? What's your favourite role you've seen him in?

FILM · COMING SOON

On the schedule

1 **England captain Harry Kane is among three England players nominated for the prestigious 2026 Ballon d'Or award.**

The Bayern Munich striker joins Jude Bellingham and Declan Rice on the shortlist. It's fantastic recognition for their incredible performances.

ON AIR – Who do you think deserves to win the Ballon d'Or this year? Can an Englishman finally lift the trophy?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 **England stars Alessia Russo and Alex Greenwood have both been nominated for the women's Ballon d'Or award.**

They are among 30 players shortlisted for the top individual honour in women's football. It highlights their impact on the global stage.

ON AIR – It's great to see more Lionesses getting recognised, isn't it? Who are you backing for the women's Ballon d'Or?
FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Liverpool midfielder Alexis Mac Allister says he is 'very sad' not to have been offered a new contract by the club.**

The Argentine international admitted he had 'options' to leave in the summer. This news will certainly get Liverpool fans talking.

ON AIR – What do you make of Mac Allister's comments? Should Liverpool have offered him a new deal?
FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Rory McIlroy admits this year's Irish Open will feel 'different' with US President Donald Trump's anticipated visit.**

Trump's presence during the tournament is expected to draw a lot of attention. It will certainly add an interesting dynamic to the event.

ON AIR – How do you think Trump's visit will affect the atmosphere at the Irish Open? Will it be a distraction for the players?
GOLF · UK

5 **Napoli have confirmed that Scotland midfielder Scott McTominay's heart surgery was a 'complete success'.**

The club expects him to resume training later this month, which is fantastic news. We wish him a speedy and full recovery.

ON AIR – It's great to hear Scott McTominay is recovering well, isn't it? How important is he to the Scotland team?
FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people transforming ordinary garden sheds into cosy 'reading nooks' or 'crafting havens'.**
It's all about making the most of available space and creating a little personal sanctuary away from the hustle and bustle of the main house. Some even add heating and comfy chairs!
- 2 The humble 'packed lunch' is having a gourmet moment, with more people elevating their midday meals.**
Forget soggy sandwiches! Folks are now opting for bento boxes with vibrant salads, homemade wraps, and even mini charcuterie selections for their work or school lunches.
- 3 A quirky study suggests that listening to 'the sound of distant church bells' can reduce stress levels.**
Researchers believe the rhythmic, calming chimes evoke a sense of tradition and peacefulness, offering a gentle auditory escape from modern life.
- 4 The delightful hobby of 'collecting unique pebbles and stones' from beach walks is seeing a charming resurgence.**
People are finding joy in the simple beauty of nature's artistry, arranging their finds in decorative bowls or even painting intricate designs on them.
- 5 A fascinating report highlights the growing popularity of 'miniature railway gardens' in private homes.**
Enthusiasts are creating intricate garden landscapes with tiny tracks, bridges, and miniature trains, bringing a touch of whimsical charm to their backyards.
- 6 More people are discovering the joy of 'upcycling old suitcases' into stylish furniture or pet beds.**
With a bit of creativity, these vintage travel companions are being given a new lease of life as coffee tables, storage chests, or snug hideaways for furry friends.
- 7 The charming tradition of 'leaving anonymous notes of kindness' in public places is spreading smiles.**
These little messages, often tucked into library books or left on park benches, offer uplifting words or compliments, brightening someone's day unexpectedly.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of jam will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: SMELLING THE LID, BEFORE OPENING IT, TO 'GET A FEEL' FOR THE FRUITINESS!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, warm piece of cake, especially if it's a new recipe. What is it?

ANSWER: ENSURING THE FORK IS PERFECTLY CLEAN BY GIVING IT AN EXTRA LITTLE WIPE, JUST IN CASE!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'shop or small business' just has a really unique and comforting smell?

Perhaps it's a bakery, a old bookshop, or even a local hardware store. Which everyday shop has a scent that instantly makes you feel happy or nostalgic, and why?

- We all have those 'little rituals' we do on a weekday morning that just make the day feel like it's started right, don't we?

It could be anything from the way you make your tea to the order you get ready. What's your essential weekday morning ritual that sets you up for the day?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a parliament.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae, which helps them identify the best leaves for their eggs.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£7.7 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£7.7 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first public park was Birkenhead Park in Merseyside, opened in 1847.
- The 'tear' in your eye that makes it water when you're crying is actually called a lachrymal punctum.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.
- There are more permutations of a standard Rubik's Cube than there are seconds in 4 billion years.
- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually helped to eradicate the Black Death in the city.
- A standard golf ball has 336 dimples.
- The sound of crickets chirping can be used to estimate the air temperature.

On this day

Day 252 of the year, 113 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Charles Lowder (Church of England); Christian feast day: Ciarán of Clonmacnoise; Christian feast day: Blessed Eurythimia Üffing; Christian feast day: Blessed Francisco Gárate Aranguren. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1987 — Nicole Aniston, American actress and model
- 1990 — Jordan Tabor, English footballer (died 2014)
- 1947 — Freddy Weller, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1943 — Frank Clark, English footballer, manager and chairman
- 1940 — Joe Negroni, American doo-wop singer (died 1978)
- 1945 — Doug Ingle, American singer-songwriter and keyboard player (died 2024)
- 1981 — Julie Gonzalo, Argentine-American actress
- 1986 — Timothy Granaderos, American actor and model

THE DAY TODAY

- 2012 — A wave of attacks kills more than 100 people and injure 350 others across Iraq.
- 2025 — Several Russian drones incur on Polish airspace and are subsequently shot down, marking the first time a NATO member has engaged Russian military assets.
- 1971 — The four-day Attica Prison riot begins, eventually resulting in 39 dead, most killed by state troopers retaking the prison.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2014 — The album Songs of Innocence by U2 is digitally released at no charge to all customers of the iTunes Music Store, appearing automatically in the "purchased" section of over 500 million users worldwide.
- 1988 — Vietnam Airlines Flight 831 crashes in Khu Khot, Thailand, while on approach to Don Muang International Airport, killing 76.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2012 — A wave of attacks kills more than 100 people and injure 350 others across Iraq.
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1970 — A British airliner is hijacked by the Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine and flown to Dawson's Field in Jordan.

- 1993 — Israeli-Palestinian peace process: The Palestine Liberation Organization officially recognizes Israel as a legitimate state.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 253 of the year, 112 days left in 2026. Today Amerindian Heritage Day (Guyana); Children's Day (Honduras); Christian feast day: Alexander Crummell (Episcopal Church); Christian feast day: Ambrose Barlow. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1942 — Danny Hutton, Irish-American singer
- 1960 — David Lowery, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1958 — Chris Columbus, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1949 — Barriemore Barlow, English rock drummer and songwriter
- 1970 — Paula Kelley, American singer-songwriter
- 1995 — Jack Grealish, English footballer
- 1969 — Johnathon Schaech, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1948 — Judy Geeson, English actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1961 — A President Airlines Douglas DC-6 crashes just after takeoff from Shannon Airport, Ireland. All 83 passengers and crew are killed.
- 1937 — Nine nations attend the Nyon Conference to address international piracy in the Mediterranean Sea.
- 2007 — Former Prime Minister of Pakistan Nawaz Sharif returns to Pakistan after seven years in exile, following a military coup in October 1999.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2025 — American right-wing political activist Charlie Kirk is assassinated while onstage at Utah Valley University in Orem, Utah.
- 2001 — During his appearance on the British TV game show *Who Wants to be a Millionaire?*, contestant Charles Ingram reaches the £1 million top prize, but it was later revealed that he had cheated to the top prize by listening to coughs from his wife and another contestant.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar